

**UNIT
8**

**ACTIVE AND
PASSIVE VOICE**

UNIT 8 ACTIVE AND PASSIVE VOICE

In active voice, the subject of the sentence performs the action.
In passive voice, the subject of the sentence receives the action.

- **Active Voice:**

The cat chases the mouse.

- **Subject:** The cat (performs the action)
- **Verb:** chased
- **Object:** the mouse (receives the action)

In this sentence, the cat is the doer of the action, and it is actively performing the chasing.

- **Passive Voice:**

The mouse is chased by the cat.

- **Subject:** The mouse (receives the action)
- **Verb:** is chased
- **Agent:** by the cat (who performs the action)

- **Rules to Convert Active into Passive Voice**

Follow these step-by-step rules for converting sentences from active to passive voice:

1) We can't make a passive if we have a non-action verb or a state verb, such as is/am/are/have/has, etc.

- **I have a car.**

A car is had by me. (Incorrect)

2) We can't make a passive if there is no object in the sentence.

- **You teach. (No passive)**

3) We can't make a passive if we have an intransitive verb (=a verb that affects the subject; not object) like go, arrive, sleep, laugh, run, cry, talk, wait, swim, fall, smile, sit, dance, jump, etc.

- **Go**

Active: She goes to school every day.

(Can't be made passive because there's no receiver of the action.)

- **Arrive**

Active: The train arrived late.

(No object, so no passive form.)

- **Sleep**

Active: The baby sleeps peacefully.

(No one is receiving the action of sleeping.)

- **Laugh**

Active: They laughed at the joke.

(Cannot be passive because "laugh" doesn't act on anyone or anything.)

- **Run**

Active: The children run in the park.

(No object to receive the action.)

Cry

- **Active:** The baby cried loudly.

(The action is happening to the baby, but "cry" has no object to be acted upon.)

- **Talk**

Active: He talks to his friends every day.
(No object, so no passive construction.)

- **Wait**

Active: We waited for the bus.
(You can't make this passive because waiting isn't done to something or someone.)

- **Swim**

Active: She swims in the pool.
(There's no receiver of the action of swimming.)

- **Fall**

Active: The leaves fall in autumn.
(No one is being "fallen" upon.)

- **Smile**

Active: He smiled at her.
(Though "smiled" seems like it could affect someone, it's still an intransitive verb because there's no direct object.)

- **Sit**

Active: The dog sat on the mat.
(No receiver of the action.)

- **Dance**

Active: She dances at the party.
(No object to act upon.)

- **Jump**

Active: He jumped over the fence.
(No object is directly affected by the action of jumping.)

4) We use passives when we focus more on the action, not its doer.

● **Examples (Focus on the Action):**

Active Voice: The teacher explained the lesson.

Passive Voice: The lesson was explained.

Active Voice: The students cleaned the classroom.

Passive Voice: The classroom was cleaned.

Active Voice: The workers built the road.

Passive Voice: The road was built.

Active Voice: The children painted the picture.

Passive Voice: The picture was painted.

- **Note:** In the examples above, when the object moves to the place of subject, it becomes subject.

5) We can't make passives in the following tenses

- Future continuous
- Present perfect continuous
- Past perfect continuous
- Future perfect continuous

5) For making passives in tenses, follow the patterns below:

● **Present Simple:**

Subject + is/am/are + verb 3rd form + by+Agent.

Subject + is/am/are + not + verb 3rd form + by+Agent.

Is/am/are + Subject + verb 3rd form + by+Agent?

Isn't / Aren't / Am I not + Subject + Verb (3rd form) + by + Agent?

- **Past Simple:**

Subject + was/were + verb 3rd form + by+Agent.

Subject + was/were + not + verb 3rd form + by+Agent.

Was/were + Subject + verb 3rd form + by+Agent?

Wasn't / Weren't + Subject + Verb (3rd form) + by + Agent?

- **Future Simple:**

Subject + will be + verb 3rd form + by +Agent.

Subject + will not be + verb 3rd form + by +Agent.

Will + subject + be + verb 3rd form + by +Agent?

Won't + Subject + be + Verb (3rd form) + by + Agent?

Example:

- The cookies are eaten by me.
- The cookies were eaten by me.
- The cookies will be eaten by me.

Active Voice: Affirmative, Negative, and Interrogative Sentences

Subject	Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative	Negative Question
Present Simple	The children eat the cookies.	The children don't eat the cookies.	Do the children eat the cookies?	Don't the children eat the cookies?
Past Simple	The children ate the cookies.	The children didn't eat the cookies.	Did the children eat the cookies?	Didn't the children eat the cookies?
Future Simple	The children will eat the cookies.	The children won't eat the cookies.	Will the children eat the cookies?	Won't the children eat the cookies?

Active Voice: Positive, Negative, and Interrogative Sentences

Subject	Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative	Negative Question
Present Simple	The cookies are eaten by the children.	The cookies aren't eaten by the children.	Are the cookies eaten by the children?	Aren't the cookies eaten by the children?

Past Simple	The cookies were eaten by the children.	The cookies weren't eaten by the children.	Were the cookies eaten by the children?	Weren't the cookies eaten by the children?
Future Simple	The cookies will be eaten by the children.	The cookies won't be eaten by the children.	Will the cookies be eaten by the children?	Won't the cookies be eaten by the children?

EXERCISES

Exercise: 1

Change the following sentences of present simple into Passive Voice.

1) He writes a letter every day.

2) She sings beautiful songs.

3) They clean the classroom after school.

4) The chef prepares delicious meals.

5) He does not open the windows at night.

6) They do not wash their clothes on weekends.

7) She does not teach science in the morning.

8) The children do not obey the rules.

9) Does he complete his tasks on time?

10) Do they celebrate festivals in the school?

Exercise: 2

Change the following sentences of past simple into Passive Voice.

1) He wrote a letter yesterday.

2) She sang a beautiful song.

3) They cleaned the classroom after the lecture.

4) The chef prepared a delicious meal.

5) He did not open the windows last night.

6) They did not wash their clothes on Saturday.

7) She did not teach maths in the afternoon.

8) The children did not follow the instructions.

9) Did he complete the task on time?

10) Did they organize the event successfully?

Exercise: 3

Change the following sentences of future simple into Passive Voice.

1) He will write a letter tomorrow.

2) She will sing a beautiful song.

3) They will clean the classroom before the event.

4) The chef will prepare a special dish.

5) He will not open the door in the evening.

6) They will not finish their homework on time.

7) She will not teach English next week.

8) The children will not obey the rules.

9) Will he complete his tasks by the deadline?

10) Will they arrange the chairs for the ceremony?

Exercise: 4

Convert the following sentences into Active Voice.

1) The book was read by the students.

2) The house will be cleaned by the maid.

3) The flowers are watered by Ali.

4) The road was repaired by the workers.

5) The homework will be completed by the children.

6) The movie is watched by the audience.

7) The thief was caught by the police.

8) The cake is baked by her every Sunday.

9) The chair was broken by someone.

10) The questions were answered by the teacher.
